

DIPLOMA IN EDUCATION PROGRAMME
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION
THE UNIVERSITY OF THE WEST INDIES, ST. AUGUSTINE

MUSIC

LESSON PLAN: #6 in Unit plan

TEACHER: Ms. Samantha Joseph **SCHOOL:** St. Joseph's Convent San Fernando

CLASS/FORM: Form 4 No. in class: 8 No of period(s): 2 Duration: 70 mins

Planning for the lesson

UNIT PLAN: From Listener to Arranger: Creating and Performing a Calypso Arrangement

TOPIC: Designing a Calypso Arrangement – solving the "Carnival Assembly" arrangement brief (selecting source material and creating an arrangement blueprint)

CONCEPT map /graphic organizer of knowledge required for lesson or Unit (to be attached separately):
See the attached Calypso: Musical + Cultural Context concept map. This lesson addresses the **Arrangement Decisions** branch (source material, structure, instrumentation, parts, texture and expression), drawing on the tools from the **Experimentation** branch (ostinato, accompaniment, call-and-response, repetition, variation and contrast).

CURRICULUM INTEGRATION AREAS across subjects and materials needed

- **Mathematics:** calculating duration from tempo and bar counts to meet the time limit (at 120 bpm in 2/4, one bar lasts one second, so a two-minute arrangement is about 120 bars); proportion between sections.
- **Language Arts:** writing clear justifications for decisions; delivering a short persuasive oral pitch.
- **Information Technology:** using MuseScore and recording devices to document and test musical ideas.
- **Social Studies:** Carnival as a cultural celebration; choosing material appropriate to a school audience and occasion.

Materials: brief envelopes; Know / Need to know / Next steps (KNN) charts; role cards; performer audit sheets; lead sheets; decision grid; chord and rhythm banks; arrangement blueprint template; planning checklist; steelpans, keyboards and percussion; laptops with MuseScore; recording devices; exit slips.

The lesson plan:

PRE-KNOWLEDGE required (what knowledge/experiences do students bring to this lesson?)

From Lessons 1–5 of the unit, students can:

- describe the musical characteristics of calypso and distinguish it from other Caribbean styles;
- perform and create rhythmic ostinatos, including the 3 + 3 + 2 calypso accent pattern;
- identify melody, bass and accompaniment roles and build simple accompaniments using primary chords (I, IV, V);
- assign appropriate roles to voices, steelpans and other instruments and create layered textures;
- map the structure of an arrangement (introduction, verse, chorus, instrumental break, ending) and identify arranging devices such as repetition, contrast, variation and call-and-response.

Strategies

Main pedagogical strategy: *Problem-based learning (PBL).* The lesson is driven by an authentic, open-ended problem: an arrangement brief from the school's Carnival Assembly Committee. The brief sets real constraints (a time limit, the performers and instruments actually available, and members with different notation-reading abilities), and there is no single correct answer. Students define the problem (Section 1), investigate and test possible solutions (Section 2), and develop and present a justified solution in the form of an arrangement blueprint (Section 3 and closure). The teacher acts as facilitator and consultant rather than the source of answers.

Supporting strategies: cooperative learning with assigned group roles, brief teacher modelling (think-aloud), teacher–group conferencing, and peer review.

Goals

At the end of this lesson/Unit, pupils will be able to

- Transform existing musical material into a coherent calypso arrangement (CSEC COMP – Composing and Arranging: mapping structure; manipulating rhythmic, melodic and harmonic material; arranging for voices and instruments).
- Apply knowledge of rhythm, melody, harmony, texture, timbre, structure and expression to make purposeful arranging decisions.
- Develop creative, critical-thinking, problem-solving and collaborative decision-making skills.
- Use notation, graphic representation and digital technology to document musical ideas.
- **HFLE (Self and Interpersonal Relationships):** negotiate, resolve disagreements constructively and share responsibility within a team.

Objectives of the lesson	Classification of objectives	Domain
1. Analyse the arrangement brief to identify at least three musical and practical constraints (purpose, duration, available performers and instruments).	Analysis	Cognitive
2. Design an arrangement blueprint that shows the structure, instrumentation and performer roles, and at least two manipulated musical elements.	Synthesis	Cognitive
3. Justify at least two key arrangement decisions with reference to calypso characteristics and the requirements of the brief.	Evaluation	Cognitive
4. Perform a 4–8-bar trial of one section of the arrangement on voices or available instruments to test a musical idea.	Manipulation	Psychomotor
5. Display shared responsibility and respect for group decisions by carrying out an assigned role and negotiating ideas constructively.	Valuing	Affective

SET INDUCTION – Time allotted: 6 minutes

"The Brief Arrives"

- The teacher plays a short excerpt of a steel orchestra's Panorama arrangement and asks, "What has the arranger done to make this tune exciting?" Students recall arranging devices from Lesson 5.
- Each group then receives a sealed envelope "from the Carnival Assembly Committee" containing the brief:

"Dear Form 4 Music Class, the Carnival Celebration Assembly needs a calypso arrangement of a familiar song to open the show. Your arrangement must: last 1½ to 2 minutes; sound recognisably calypso; change at least two musical elements from the original (e.g. rhythm, harmony, texture, instrumentation, structure); be playable by YOUR group using instruments available in the music room; and give every member a part suited to her ability. Please present your plan for approval at the end of today's lesson. – The Committee"

- The teacher writes the driving question on the board: *"How can we turn a familiar song into a calypso arrangement that our group can perform well in two minutes?"*

SECTION 1 – Time allotted: *12 minutes* (Define the problem)

Teaching points:

- Every arrangement responds to constraints: purpose and audience, duration, the performers' abilities and the instruments available.
- Suitable source material is recognisable to the audience, can be adapted to a duple calypso feel, and fits the range of the available voices and instruments.
- Clear group roles make problem-solving more efficient and give every member responsibility.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Problem analysis (facilitation). The teacher asks: "What does the brief require? What do we already know from Lessons 1–5 that will help? What do we still need to find out?" She does not supply solutions; she redirects questions back to the group.	Groups of 4–5 assign roles: Facilitator, Scribe, Rhythm Director, Harmony/Pan Director and Timekeeper/Recorder. They complete the KNN chart: constraints from the brief, relevant prior knowledge (e.g. 3 + 3 + 2 pattern, call-and-response, layering) and questions to investigate.	• The brief • KNN chart • Role cards
Performer audit. The teacher prompts: "Who can play what? Who reads notation? What range can your voices sing comfortably?"	Groups complete a performer audit listing each member's instrument(s), confidence level and vocal range, and check which instruments are available in the music room.	• Performer audit sheet • Instrument inventory list

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 3 minutes (within Section 1)

- Each group's Facilitator states the group's top three constraints and one "need to know" question.
- The teacher clarifies any misreadings of the brief and checks the KNN charts against Objective 1.

SECTION 2 – Time allotted: 25 minutes (Investigate and generate possible solutions)

Teaching points:

- Criteria for choosing source material: familiarity, a simple harmonic structure (e.g. I–IV–V), and a melody that adapts well to syncopation.
- Ways to manipulate musical elements: rhythmic (resetting the melody with syncopation, adding a 3 + 3 + 2 accompaniment ostinato); harmonic (adding a bass line, changing voicings or adding passing chords); textural (starting thin and building layers); structural (adding an introduction, instrumental break, call-and-response chorus or tag ending); timbral (moving the melody between voice, steelpan and keyboard); expressive (tempo, dynamics and articulation).
- Duration planning: at 120 bpm in 2/4, one bar ≈ one second, so a two-minute arrangement is about 120 bars.
- Testing ideas in sound and recording the trials is part of the arranging process.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Brief modelling (think-aloud, 4 minutes). Using a song that is not on the shortlist ("Happy Birthday"), the teacher thinks aloud through one decision only: converting the melody to a calypso feel and adding a 3 + 3 + 2 accompaniment. She stops there and leaves all further decisions to the groups.	Students observe and note the questions the teacher asked herself (e.g. "What is the original feel? How can I make it syncopated? Who could play the accompaniment?").	• Keyboard or steelpan • Whiteboard
Selecting source material. The teacher provides a shortlist with lead sheets (e.g. the Caribbean folk songs "Brown Girl in the Ring" and "Mango Walk", and the school song) and invites groups to propose their own song for approval. She asks: "Which song best fits YOUR constraints, and why?"	Groups sing or play through two options and evaluate each against the brief and their performer audit using a decision grid. They choose one song and record their reasons.	• Lead sheets • Decision grid • Keyboards and steelpans
Generating and testing ideas (conferencing). The teacher circulates as a consultant, holding a short	Groups try at least two options at the instruments (e.g. two accompaniment ostinatos or two	• Chord bank and rhythm bank • Steelpans, keyboards, percussion

conference with each group and asking open questions, e.g. “What will make the listener recognise this as calypso within the first four bars?” “Is that part realistic for your performers?” She directs groups to the chord and rhythm banks rather than providing answers.	introductions), record short trials and choose the most effective. The Rhythm and Harmony/Pan Directors lead the trials; the Timekeeper calculates the number of bars needed to meet the time limit.	• Recording devices • Laptops with MuseScore

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 5 minutes (within Section 2)

- **Mid-point check-in:** each group plays a 4–8-bar trial of one idea for a neighbouring group (Objective 4).
- The listening group responds with one strength and one question, using two criteria: “Does it sound like calypso?” and “Is it playable by this group?”
- The teacher records each trial on the observation checklist.

SECTION 3 – Time allotted: 15 minutes (Develop and present the solution: the arrangement blueprint)

Teaching points:

- A blueprint documents the structure (sections, bar counts and timing), instrumentation and performer roles, the element(s) manipulated in each section, and expressive markings (tempo and dynamics).
- A strong justification links each key decision to (a) the characteristics of calypso and (b) the constraints in the brief.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Blueprint completion. The teacher distributes the blueprint template and the planning checklist (success criteria). She confers with any group that is stuck, using questions to prompt rather than instructions.	Groups complete the blueprint: sections with bar counts and timing, who plays what, and at least two clearly labelled manipulated elements. The Scribe records while all members contribute ideas.	• Arrangement blueprint template • Planning checklist
Justification. The teacher asks each group to write two “because” statements (“We chose… because…”) that link	Groups write two justifications and check them against the planning checklist.	• Justification prompt on the blueprint template

decisions to calypso features and to the brief.		

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) Time allotted: 3 minutes (within Section 3)

- **Peer review:** groups swap blueprints with a neighbouring group, tick off the planning-checklist criteria they can see, and write one question for the other group.
- The teacher spot-checks blueprints and peer comments.

CLOSURE (How will you end the lesson?)– Time allotted: 6 minutes

- **"Committee pitch":** each group's Facilitator gives a 30-second pitch naming the source song, explaining how it will sound like calypso, and identifying the two manipulated elements.
- The teacher, as "Committee Chair", responds with "Approved" or "Approved with conditions" (e.g. "Approved – check that your duration fits the time limit").
- The teacher returns to the driving question and highlights the problem-solving process the groups used: define, investigate, test, decide and justify.
- Link to Lesson 7: "In rehearsal we will find out whether your plan works in sound, and you will revise it where needed."

FINAL EVALUATION – Time allotted: 6 minutes

Reasonable level of achievement: at least 80% of groups produce a blueprint scoring 7 out of 10 or higher, and every student completes the individual exit slip.

Evidence collected:

- **Group:** KNN chart, completed arrangement blueprint with justifications, and the observation checklist record of the trial performance.
- **Individual exit slip** (individual accountability within the group task): "My role today was… One decision I contributed to, and why…"

Objective 5 is assessed through the teacher's observation of group roles and the individual exit slips.

Table of Specification

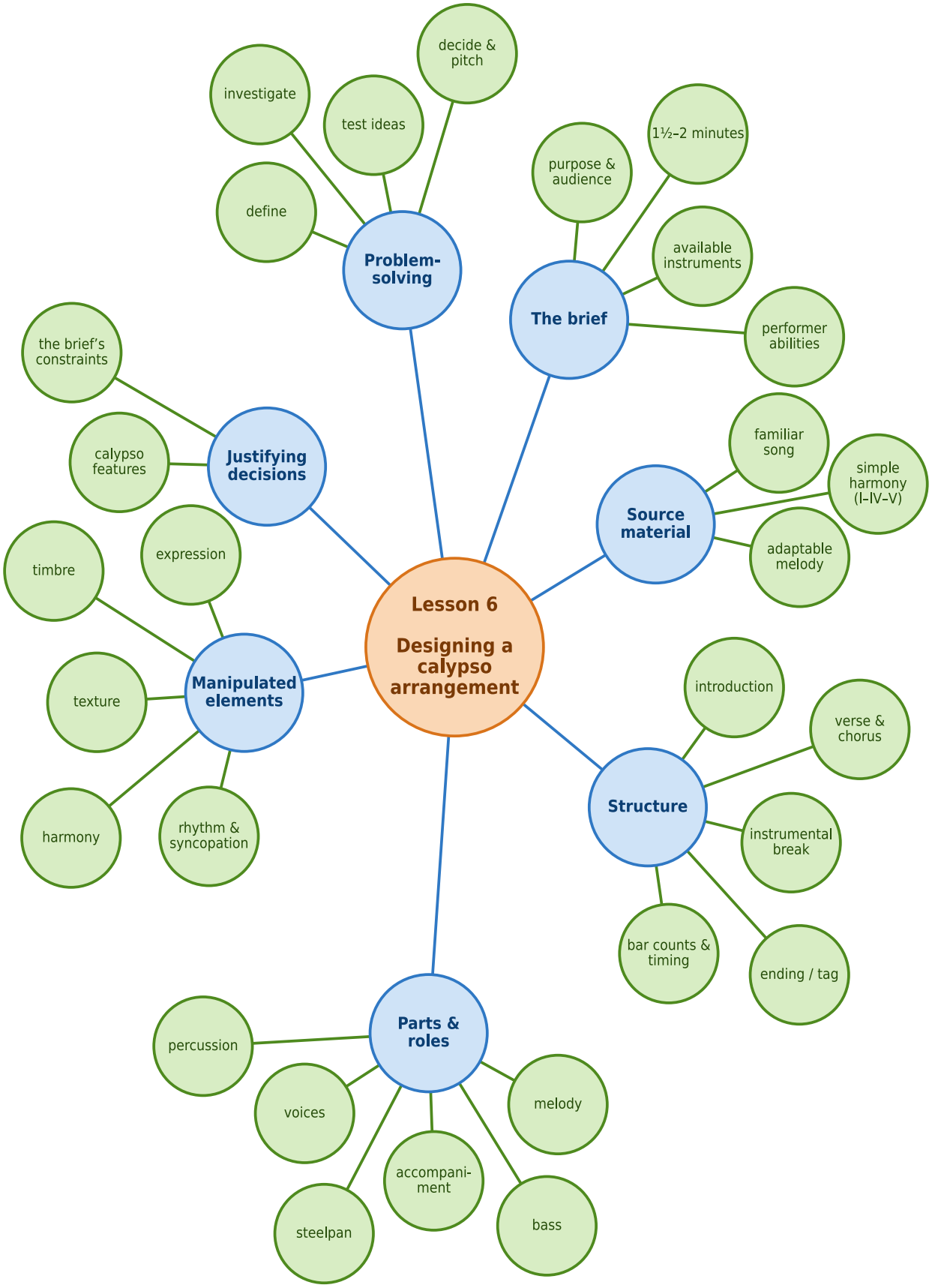
Objective	Assessment Item	Domain/Level	Marks	% of total
1. Identify the constraints in the brief	KNN chart	Cognitive – Analysis	2	20%
2. Design an arrangement blueprint	Blueprint: structure (1), instrumentation and roles (1), two manipulated elements (2)	Cognitive – Synthesis	4	40%
3. Justify arrangement decisions	Two "because" statements	Cognitive – Evaluation	2	20%
4. Perform a trial of one section	Observation checklist (mid-point check-in)	Psychomotor – Manipulation	2	20%
5. Shared responsibility and respect for group decisions	Observation of roles and individual exit slip	Affective – Valuing	-	-
Total			**10**	**100%**

The blueprint is assessed with the planning checklist; the teacher's conference notes provide additional formative evidence for Lesson 7.

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES/LESSON:

- Groups address any "conditions" from the committee pitch and finalise their blueprints.
- Each group notates its parts in MuseScore or as graphic scores, matched to members' notation-reading abilities.
- Students practise their individual parts before the next lesson.
- **Next lesson (Lesson 7 – Rehearsing, Evaluating and Revising):** groups rehearse their arrangements, record excerpts, identify problems and revise using the problem → musical solution → revised arrangement process.

Concept Map:


Lesson 6
Designing a calypso arrangement
Problem-solving
investigate
test ideas
decide & pitch
define
The brief
purpose & audience
1½–2 minutes
available instruments
performer abilities
Source material
familiar song
simple harmony (I–IV–V)
adaptable melody
Justifying decisions
the brief's constraints
calypso features
Manipulated elements
expression
timbre
texture
harmony
rhythm & syncopation
Structure
introduction
verse & chorus
instrumental break
bar counts & timing
ending / tag
Parts & roles
percussion
voices
steelpan
accompani-ment
melody
bass